SHERPA PROS · COMPETITIVE ANALYSIS · 2026

Competitive Landscape

The licensed + code-aware + true-marketplace quadrant is empty.

Phyrom · Founder · HJD Builders LLC Pre-seed · 2026 Confidential

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The structural gap

Home-services platforms split three ways:

- **Lead-gen pay-to-play** (Angi, Thumbtack) — pros buy contacts, not jobs
- **Task-based gig** (TaskRabbit, Handy) — unskilled labor, no licensed-trade depth
- **Designer/inspiration marketplaces** (Houzz) — aspirational, not execution

All have well-documented structural weaknesses around licensed-trade verification, code/permit awareness, and contractor economics.

State-run installer-finders (Mass Save) cover narrow scope (energy efficiency), no marketplace mechanics — no dispatch, no escrow, no review system.

Sherpa Pros plants the flag in the empty quadrant.

4 layers, 1 platform

Labor + Materials + Delivery + Coordination

Single-layer incumbents do their layer well, do not own customer relationship across the other three.

The coordination cost the homeowner pays today is exactly the cost Sherpa Pros eliminates by integrating across all four.

The four layers, the incumbent leaders

LAYER	WHAT IT DOES	INCUMBENTS	SHERPA PROS
1. Labor	Match licensed pro	Angi · Thumbtack · TaskRabbit · Houzz Pro	**Sherpa Marketplace** — code-aware, 5–10% take, Stripe escrow
2. Materials	Source parts	FW Webb · Grainger · Home Depot Pro · supplyhouse.com	**Sherpa Materials engine** — auto-derives parts list, Zinc API
3. Last-mile	Same-day delivery	Uber Direct · DoorDash Drive · Roadie	**Uber Direct** integrated as the rail inside Sherpa Materials
4. Coordination	Multi-trade timeline	BuildBook · BuilderTrend · JobNimbus · Procore	**Sherpa Dispatch** — sequences handoffs, surfaces blockers

Sherpa Pros is the only player vertically integrating all four layers under one orchestration plane.

I.

Per-Competitor Analysis

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Angi (NASDAQ: ANGI)

FY2025 revenue $1.03B (down 13% YoY) · Spun off from IAC Q2 2025

Model: Lead-gen — $30–$100/lead, often shared with up to 40 competitors. Angi Pro subscription starts $200/mo.

Documented weaknesses:

- BBB: not accredited; **1,800+ complaints** 2023–2026
- **Trustpilot 2.1/5** with thousands of 1-star pro reviews
- **Vermont AG settlement Oct 2025** — $100K over misleading "Certified Pro" terminology
- 30% cancellation penalty on remaining contract balance

Sherpa Pros advantage: 5% beta take (10% post-beta) vs. Angi's effective $400–$800/closed-job spend. Code-aware quote validation. "Jobs not leads" — exclusive matching, not lead-blast.

Thumbtack

~$400M FY2024 revenue · $3.2B valuation (June 2021) · ~$699M raised

Model: Lead-gen — pros pay variable per-quote price; consumers post job; pros buy contact.

Documented weaknesses:

- Documented **contractor-deposit-theft cases** ($300–$6,500 per BBB/Sitejabber)
- Widely-reported **fake leads** (invalid phone, non-existent customers)
- BBB **pattern-of-complaints review completed Nov 2025**
- Does not mediate "price disagreements" with deposit-keeping contractors

Sherpa Pros advantage: Stripe Connect escrow with 7-day hold reduces deposit-theft risk. License + insurance verified before listing. No shared/blasted leads — single matched dispatch.

TaskRabbit (acquired by IKEA 2017)

~$75M revenue 2025 (private subsidiary, not separately disclosed)

Model: Hybrid hourly tasker rates — 15% service fee + 7.5% trust/support fee = **22.5% effective fee load.** IKEA assembly on flat per-item pricing.

Coverage: Unskilled tasks (assembly, moving, errands, cleaning, handyman). **Does not cover licensed trades** (electrical, plumbing, HVAC, roofing).

Documented weaknesses: High effective fee. Last-minute cancellations. IKEA-flat-rate roll-out cut tasker earnings. Not built for code-bound or permitted work.

Sherpa Pros advantage: Different category. When TaskRabbit users need licensed work (electrical for ceiling fan, plumbing for dishwasher), they have nowhere to go inside the platform — Sherpa Pros captures that referral.

Handy (acquired by ANGI 2018, $165.5M)

Not separately disclosed since acquisition (rolled into ANGI consolidated revenue)

Model: Subscription + per-task; pre-priced cleaning, handyman, basic installs.

Coverage: Narrow — cleaning, handyman, basic furniture/TV installs. Limited licensed-trade coverage.

Documented weaknesses: Limited trade coverage means most homeowner-significant projects (heat pump, panel upgrade, roof, plumbing rough-in) cannot be booked. ANGI parent absorbs strategic priority away from Handy.

Sherpa Pros advantage: Covers the licensed-trade depth Handy explicitly avoids. We own the **high-ticket workflow ($5K–$50K jobs)** where Handy stops at ~$300 tasks.

Houzz

~$4B valuation · $614M total raised from Sequoia/NEA/GGV

Model: Houzz consumer marketplace (free directory + lead-gen) + **Houzz Pro SaaS** $59–$999/mo per seat.

Documented weaknesses:

- **Houzz Pro: 1.03★ BBB across 500+ complaints** in 3 years
- **Sitejabber 2.5★** over 159 reviews
- Contractors report **$5K+ spend with zero leads**
- Lead-blast model (customers contact many pros from one listing)
- 2024 industry-wide design-firm revenue decline; valuation markdown filings

Sherpa Pros advantage: Houzz competes on aspirational visuals; we compete on **completing the job today**. Code-aware quote validation is execution-grade, not portfolio-grade.

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Mass Save Find-an-Installer

Utility-funded program tool (Eversource, National Grid, Unitil, etc.) — N/A revenue, non-commercial.

Model: Basic listing only. Zip-code search returns EPA-certified contractors.

Coverage: Energy efficiency only — heat pumps, HPC contractors, insulation/air-sealing IICs.

Critical gap: No marketplace mechanics. No dispatch, no escrow, no scheduling, no quotes, no reviews, no in-app messaging, no payment, no permit assist, no rebate calculator, no matching algorithm. **It is a static listing.**

Sherpa Pros opportunity: Become the **execution layer** Mass Save's listing is missing. Apply for Mass Save Network → inherit funnel → provide dispatch/escrow/review layer the program cannot.

II.

Capability Heatmap

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At a glance

CAPABILITY	ANGI	THUMBTACK	TASKRABBIT	HANDY	HOUZZ	MASS SAVE	SHERPA PROS
Licensed-trade verification	weak	weak	n/a	weak	weak	partial	**full**
Code intelligence (NEC/IRC)	×	×	×	×	×	partial	✓
Permit-aware quoting	×	×	×	×	×	×	✓
Rebate-aware (Mass Save)	×	×	×	×	×	✓	✓
Escrow / payment protection	×	×	partial	✓	×	×	✓
Single-pro dispatch	×	×	✓	✓	×	×	✓
Take-rate vs. lead-fee	lead	lead	22.5%	15–20%	lead+SaaS	n/a	**5–10%**
Founder-built by working GC	×	×	×	×	×	×	✓
PM tier (CapEx/OpEx, NOI)	×	×	×	×	×	×	✓

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What we don't compete on

Stating this clearly de-risks the pitch ("they understand their lane"):

01 **TaskRabbit-style assembly + errands** — gig-economy unskilled. We link out to TaskRabbit when needed.

02 **Houzz-style designer portfolios** — Houzz owns aspirational. Belle Vie (sister property) handles design-concierge.

03 **Home Depot / Lowe's "Pro Services" installs** — tied to retail purchase channels. **Partnership** (materials integration via Zinc), not competition.

04 **Pure SaaS for contractors** (Houzz Pro, Buildertrend) — we don't sell a contractor CRM.

05 **National handyman chains** (Mr. Handyman, Ace) — franchise plays with W-2 tradespeople. Different supply model.

06 **Insurance-tied repair networks** (Servpro, Belfor) — carrier referral lock-in. **Future partnership** (Phase 4).

07 **New-construction GC selection** (BuildZoom, NewHomeSource) — months-long six-figure relationship sale. We focus on $500–$50K jobs.

Defensibility — five moats

01 **Code-aware quote validation** (NEC, IRC, MA Electrical, NH RSA — 192 codes, 480K entries, 284 NH municipalities) — multi-year build no national lead-gen incumbent has incentive to replicate.

02 **Founder-as-GC narrative** (Phyrom of HJD Builders, actively building in NH) — unforgeable trust signal vs. corporate platforms.

03 **Mass Save Network application + Eversource / National Grid Turnkey relationships** — utility-funnel lock-in competitors cannot enter without state-level certification.

04 **5% take rate (Founding Pros forever)** vs. Angi's effective $400–$800/closed-job lead spend — permanent supply-side cost advantage.

05 **Old-House Verified USPTO trademark** — defensible branded category for pre-1950 Boston/triple-decker work no platform owns.

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